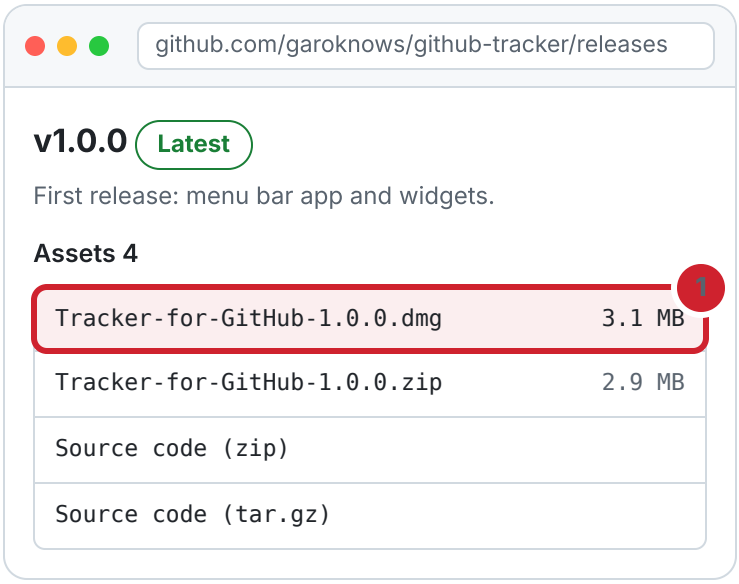
Install and use Tracker for GitHub

A plain-language guide for anyone. Download the app, approve it once, then add the people you want to follow. About 5 minutes. Works on macOS 14 Sonoma or later.

1 Download the app

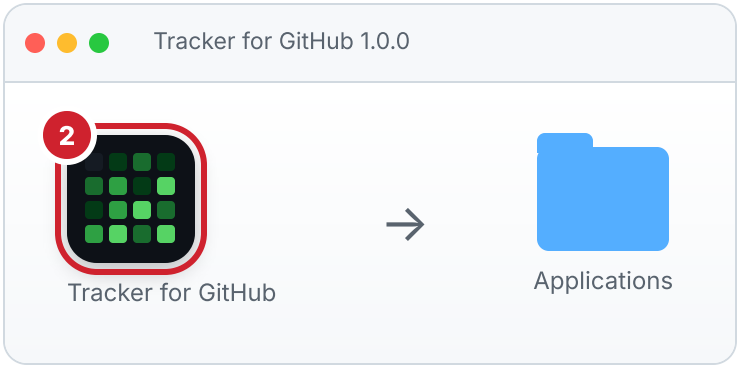
1. Go to `github.com/garoknows/github-tracker`.
2. On the right side, click **Releases**, then the newest version.
3. Under **Assets**, click the file ending in `.dmg`. It lands in your Downloads folder.



1 Click the .dmg file. Ignore "Source code" unless you plan to build it yourself.

2 Drag it into Applications

1. Double-click the downloaded `.dmg`. A small window opens.
2. Drag the **Tracker for GitHub** icon onto the **Applications** folder.
3. Close the window, then drag the disk icon off your desktop (or right-click it and choose **Eject**).



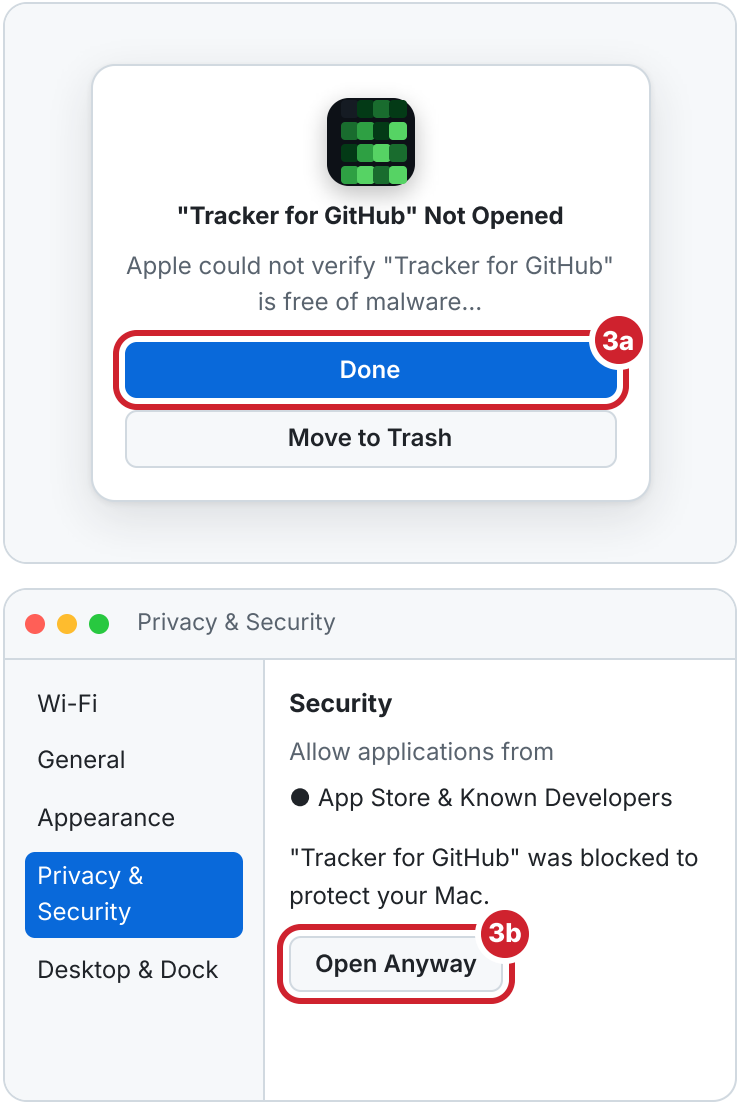
2 Drag the app icon onto the Applications folder.

3 Approve it the first time

Because this free app isn't signed by Apple yet, your Mac blocks the first launch. That's normal for indie open-source apps. You approve it once:

1. Open **Applications** and double-click **Tracker for GitHub**. A warning appears. Click **Done**.
2. Open **System Settings** → **Privacy & Security**.
3. Scroll down to **Security**. Next to "Tracker for GitHub was blocked," click **Open Anyway**.
4. Confirm with your password or Touch ID, then click **Open Anyway** again.

> On macOS 15 and later, the old right-click → Open trick no longer works. Use System Settings as shown.

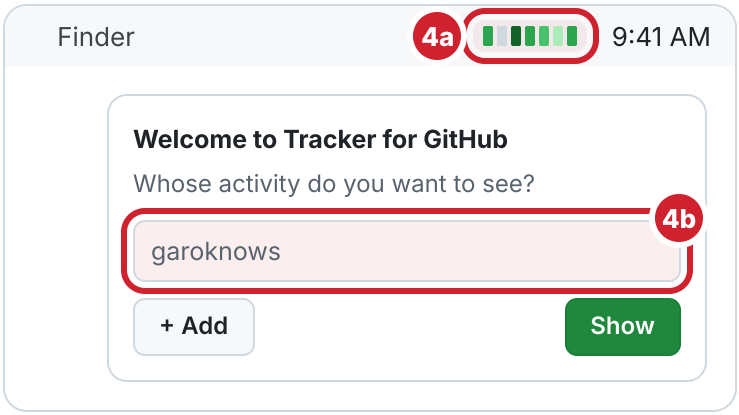


3a Click Done on the warning. **3b** Then click Open Anyway in Privacy & Security.

4 Add yourself and your favorites

1. Look at the top-right of your screen. Click the small graph icon in the menu bar.
2. Type a GitHub username, an @handle, or paste a profile link (like `github.com/garoknows`). Press **Return**.
3. Click **+ Add** to save more people, up to 10.
4. Flip between them with a two-finger swipe, the ← → keys, or the ◀ ▶ buttons.

> Want it to start automatically? Open **Settings** in the popover and turn on **Launch at login**.

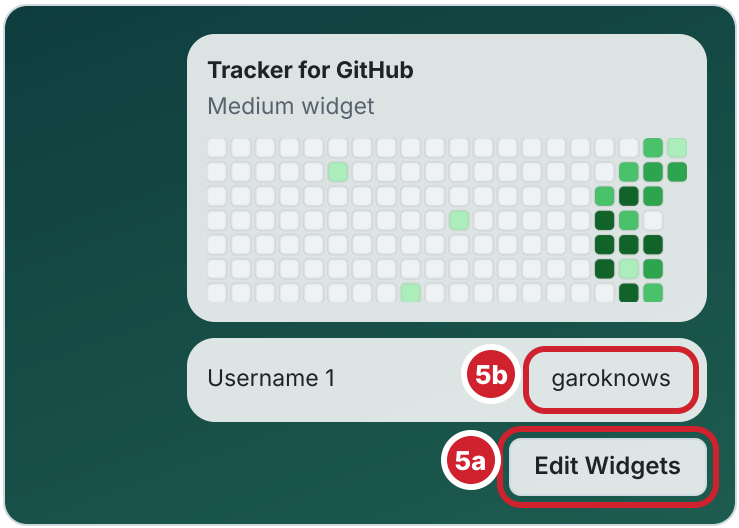


4a The menu bar icon. **4b** Type a username and press Return.

5 Put it on your desktop or in Notification Center

1. Click the **date and time** in the menu bar to open Notification Center. Scroll to the bottom and click **Edit Widgets**. (For the desktop: right-click the desktop → **Edit Widgets**.)
2. Search for **Tracker**. Pick Small, Medium or Large and drag it where you want.
3. Right-click the new widget → **Edit Widget** and type up to 5 usernames.
4. On Medium and Large widgets, click ◀ ▶ to flip between them.

> Widgets can't be swiped on a Mac. That's an Apple limit, which is why they have buttons.



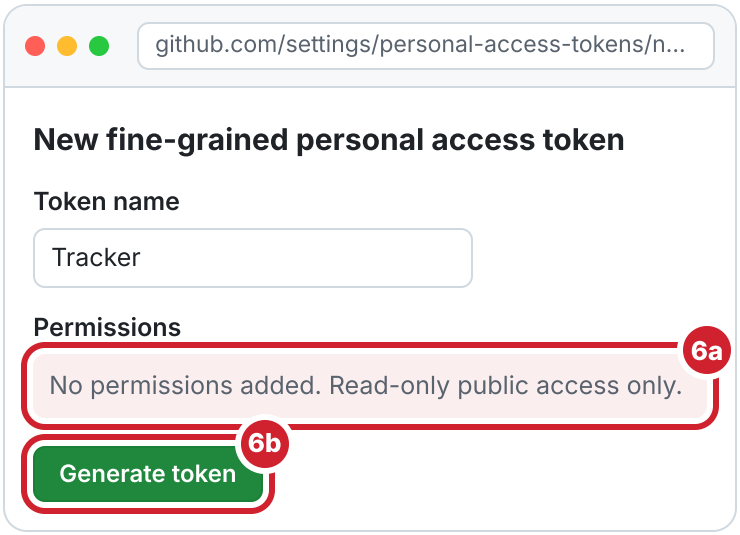
5a Edit Widgets at the bottom of Notification Center. **5b** Edit Widget lets you type usernames.

6 Optional: unlock the quadrant chart with a token

The four-way Commits / Issues / Pull requests / Code review chart sometimes needs a free GitHub "token" (a read-only key). It can't change anything on your account.

1. On github.com, click your picture → **Settings** → **Developer settings** → **Personal access tokens** → **Fine-grained tokens**.
2. Click **Generate new token**. Name it "Tracker", pick an expiration, and leave every permission off.
3. Click **Generate token** and copy it. GitHub shows it only once.
4. In the app: **Settings** → **GitHub token** → paste → **Test token**.

> The token is stored in your Mac's Keychain and sent only to GitHub. Delete it anytime on GitHub.



6a Leave permissions empty. **6b** Generate, copy, and paste into the app's Settings.

Build it yourself (for developers)

Building from source skips the security warning because the app was made on your own Mac. You need Xcode (free in the Mac App Store). Run these one at a time in Terminal:

```
git clone https://github.com/garoknows/github-tracker.git
```

```
cd github-tracker
```

```
./scripts/install.sh
```

The script builds the app, copies it into Applications and opens it.

Update or remove

- **Update:** Settings → About → **Check for updates** opens the newest release. Download it and drag it into Applications, replacing the old one.
- **Remove:** click the menu bar icon → **Quit**, remove any widgets (Edit Widgets → ⊖), then drag the app from Applications to the Trash.

FAQ

<details>
<summary>Why does my Mac warn me about this app?</summary>

Apple only fully trusts apps from developers who pay for a yearly Apple Developer membership. This project is free and doesn't have that yet. The source code is public so anyone can check what it does.
</details>

<details>
<summary>Why is the quadrant chart missing for someone?</summary>

GitHub only shows it for people who turned on "Activity overview" in their profile settings. If they did and it's still missing, add a token in Settings (step 6).
</details>

<details>
<summary>Does it show private work?</summary>

Only as anonymous green squares, and only if that person turned on "Private contributions" on their GitHub profile. It never shows private repo names or code.
</details>

<details>
<summary>What data does it collect?</summary>

None. There's no account, no server and no analytics. It only downloads public data from GitHub and keeps a small cache on your Mac so it works offline.
</details>

<details>
<summary>Why can't I swipe the widget?</summary>

macOS widgets only support clicks on buttons. Swiping works in the menu bar popover.
</details>